DSEH004 Performance Management and Employee Engagement

Week 12 | Lecture 3 | Synthesis

Course Synthesis and Exam Preparation

Diagnosis, design, strategy and culture as one argument

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Commit before theory

If you could keep only one idea from this course, which would best explain why performance management so often fails?

A

Appraisal forms are badly designed

B

Systems depend on the relationship between manager and employee

C

Employees are not motivated enough

D

Organizations measure the wrong things

The course as one argument

Diagnose (Unit II)

Kahn, JD-R, SDT, flow, PsyCap: what drives engagement and strain

Design (Unit I)

Goals, OKRs, scorecards, coaching, feedback: what the system should do

Strategize (Unit III)

Drivers, horizons, lifecycle, segments: where to act and for whom

Sustain (Unit IV)

Strengths, careers, mentoring, HPWS, recognition, culture

Three verdicts on performance management

1 A century of progress?

DeNisi and Murphy (2017): research improved rating accuracy, but less is known about improving performance itself

2 Why PM is broken

Pulakos and O'Leary (2011): the problem is the manager-employee relationship, not the form

3 A motivational frame

DeNisi and Pritchard (2006): appraisal improves performance only through motivation

Pairs of theories examiners like to compare

Pair	Common ground	Key difference
Kahn and JD-R	Both explain engagement	Psychological conditions versus demands and resources
SDT and goal setting	Both explain motivation	Quality of motivation versus direction and intensity of effort
OKRs and balanced scorecard	Both cascade strategy	Stretch and transparency versus balance across perspectives
Mentoring and sponsorship	Both support careers	Advice versus advocacy
Contract breach and trust	Both explain betrayal	Content of promises versus trustworthiness

How the end-term is marked

1 Concepts, about 30%

Accurate definitions and correct attribution of theories

2 Application, about 35%

Theory used on the case, not described in general

3 Critique, about 20%

Limits, trade offs and evidence quality

4 Integration, about 15%

Links across units and Indian examples

Five questions with internal choice: four of 20 marks and one of 10, in three hours

A 20-mark answer in four moves

Define

Name the concepts the question turns on, with authors

Apply

Use two theories on the case, step by step

Critique

State the evidence and its limits

Conclude

Make a recommendation and name what would change it

Exam-style question

Performance management systems fail not because of poor design but because of poor relationships. Critically evaluate this statement using theories from at least three units of the course. (20 marks)

What a strong answer does

- Uses Pulakos and O'Leary and DeNisi and Murphy as the frame
- Brings in diagnosis theories such as JD-R or SDT
- Brings in design or culture theories such as goal setting or psychological safety
- Takes a position, with evidence and limits

Sources

DeNisi, A. S., & Murphy, K. R. (2017). Performance appraisal and performance management: 100 years of progress? Journal of Applied Psychology, 102(3), 421-433. https://doi.org/10.1037/apl0000085

DeNisi, A. S., & Pritchard, R. D. (2006). Performance appraisal, performance management and improving individual performance. Management and Organization Review, 2(2), 253-277. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1740-8784.2006.00042.x

Pulakos, E. D., & O'Leary, R. S. (2011). Why is performance management broken? Industrial and Organizational Psychology, 4(2), 146-164. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1754-9434.2011.01315.x